



DAYALBAGH EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTE

Department of Electrical Engineering

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DIY PROJECT REPORT

PORTABLE BATTERY CHARGING CIRCUIT

Submitted by:

Khyati Parashar

Roll No: 2400886

Huda Khan

Roll No: 2400958

Varalika Sharma

Roll No: 2400993

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Abstract

This report documents the end-to-end design, simulation, physical assembly, and verified testing of a portable battery charging circuit built around the LM7805 three-terminal linear voltage regulator. The circuit accepts a standard 9V battery as input and delivers a stable, regulated 5V DC output through a USB Type-A connector, making it suitable for charging smartphones, earbuds, and other USB-powered devices in the field. Key design features include reverse polarity protection via a 1N4007 rectifier diode, dual-stage input and output filtering using electrolytic and ceramic capacitors, and an LED power indicator for real-time operational feedback.

The design was realized in two parallel tracks: a professional PCB layout developed in KiCad 7.0 (complete with schematic, 2D layout, and 3D rendered views), and a hands-on prototype built and soldered on a zero PCB board. Physical testing using a Jackly digital multimeter confirmed an output voltage of 4.99V from a partially discharged 7.95V input battery — representing just 0.2% deviation from the 5V target and demonstrating excellent voltage regulation performance. The measured efficiency at these operating conditions reached 62.8%, slightly higher than the theoretical 55.5% due to the reduced voltage differential across the regulator at lower input voltages.

This project provided comprehensive practical exposure to voltage regulator theory, thermal analysis, capacitor filtering, PCB design principles using KiCad EDA software, zero PCB assembly, soldering techniques, and systematic circuit testing — forming a complete and verified engineering design exercise.

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1. Introduction

1.1 Project Overview

The growing dependence on portable electronic devices has created an ever-increasing demand for compact, reliable, and efficient power conversion solutions. From smartphones and wireless earbuds to embedded microcontroller systems, a stable 5V supply is one of the most universally required voltage levels in modern electronics. This project addresses that fundamental need by designing a portable battery charging circuit that steps down a standard 9V battery to a regulated, noise-free 5V USB output.

At the heart of the design is the LM7805 — a three-terminal linear positive voltage regulator that has remained an industry staple for over four decades due to its simplicity, robustness, and reliable regulation characteristics. The circuit is intentionally kept minimal in component count while incorporating all essential protection and filtering features required for safe, practical operation. The design was implemented both as a professional KiCad PCB layout and as a physical prototype on a zero PCB board, which was subsequently tested with actual voltage measurements.

1.2 Project Objectives

- Design a complete voltage regulator circuit converting 9V battery input to stable 5V USB output
- Implement reverse polarity protection to safeguard all downstream components
- Incorporate dual-stage input and output filtering to minimize voltage ripple and noise
- Include an LED power indicator for visual operational confirmation
- Develop a professional 2-layer PCB layout in KiCad with schematic, 2D, and 3D views
- Physically assemble and solder the circuit on a zero PCB board
- Verify circuit performance through actual voltage measurements using a digital multimeter

1.3 Applications

- Emergency mobile phone charging in areas without access to mains power
- Portable power supply for Arduino, Raspberry Pi, and other embedded systems
- Charging station for Bluetooth earbuds, smartwatches, and fitness trackers
- Field power bank for outdoor activities, trekking, and camping
- Educational platform for learning analog circuit design and PCB development
- Automotive USB charging using 12V vehicle battery (with minor modification)

2. Block Diagram

2.1 System Block Diagram

The following block diagram illustrates the complete signal flow of the portable battery charging circuit from the 9V battery input to the USB output:

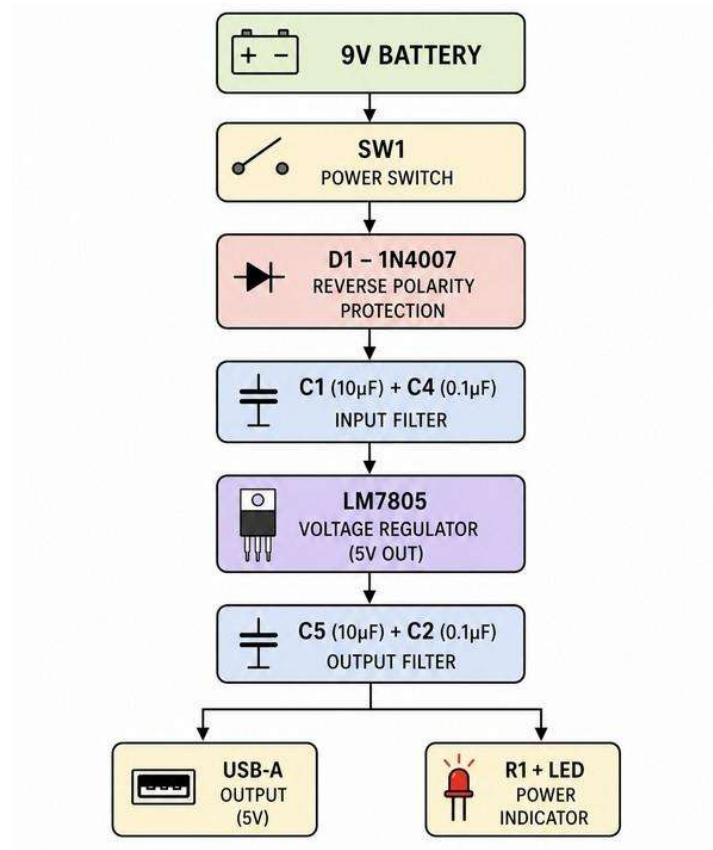


Figure 2.1: System Block Diagram

2.2 Working Principle

The 9V battery voltage is first switched ON/OFF using SW1. It then passes through the 1N4007 diode (D1) which drops 0.7V and blocks any reverse polarity connection. The filtered input voltage reaches the LM7805 which steps it down to a stable 5V regardless of input fluctuations. Output capacitors smooth the regulated voltage before delivery to the USB-A connector for charging devices. The red LED indicator glows continuously to confirm the circuit is operating correctly.

3. Theoretical Background

3.1 Voltage Regulation Fundamentals

Voltage regulation is the process of maintaining a constant, stable output voltage despite variations in input voltage or load current. In any battery-powered system, the terminal voltage of a battery drops progressively as it discharges, and load current variations cause further fluctuations. Without regulation, these variations would be directly passed to sensitive electronic loads, causing malfunction or damage.

Linear voltage regulators address this problem using a series pass element — typically a bipolar junction transistor or MOSFET — placed between the input and output in series. A feedback loop continuously monitors the output voltage and adjusts the pass element's resistance to compensate for any deviation. When output voltage drops due to increased load, the pass transistor's resistance decreases to allow more current. When it rises, resistance increases. This constant adjustment maintains a stable output at the cost of dissipating the voltage difference as heat.

The key performance parameters of a voltage regulator are line regulation (output change per unit input voltage change), load regulation (output change per unit load current change), dropout voltage (minimum input-output voltage difference for proper operation), and thermal resistance (heat dissipation capability). The LM7805 achieves 3mV typical line regulation and 15mV typical load regulation — excellent figures for a linear regulator.

3.2 LM7805 Voltage Regulator IC

The LM7805 belongs to the 78xx series of three-terminal fixed positive voltage regulators manufactured by multiple vendors including Texas Instruments and ON Semiconductor. It provides a fixed 5V output with a maximum output current of 1.5A, making it suitable for a wide range of low to medium power applications.

3.2.1 Key Electrical Specifications

Parameter	Typical Value	Maximum Value
Output Voltage	5.00V	5.00V +/- 0.2V
Maximum Output Current	1.5A	1.5A
Input Voltage Range	7V to 35V	35V
Dropout Voltage	2V	2V minimum
Line Regulation	3mV	100mV maximum
Load Regulation	15mV	100mV maximum
Quiescent Current	4.2mA	8mA maximum
Output Noise Voltage	40 uV	—
Ripple Rejection	62dB at 120Hz	—
Thermal Shutdown	150 deg C	150 deg C

3.2.2 Internal Architecture

Internally, the LM7805 contains four key functional blocks. The bandgap voltage reference generates a precise, temperature-stable reference voltage of approximately 1.25V regardless of input voltage or temperature. The error amplifier compares a scaled sample of the output voltage against this reference and produces a control signal proportional to the difference. The series pass transistor, driven by the error amplifier output, acts as a variable resistor that drops the excess voltage between input and output. Finally, built-in current limiting and thermal shutdown circuits provide protection against overload and excessive temperature, making the device essentially self-protecting under fault conditions.

3.3 Protection Mechanisms

3.3.1 Reverse Polarity Protection

The 1N4007 diode placed in series with the battery positive terminal provides complete reverse polarity protection. If the 9V battery is accidentally connected with reversed terminals, the diode is reverse biased and blocks all current flow, protecting the LM7805 and every component downstream from damage. In normal forward operation, the diode introduces a forward voltage drop of 0.7V to 1.1V at operating currents, so a 9V battery delivers approximately 8.3V to the LM7805 input — comfortably above the 7V minimum required for regulation.

3.3.2 Thermal Protection

The LM7805 incorporates internal thermal shutdown circuitry that automatically limits power dissipation when the junction temperature approaches 150 degrees C. This protection is entirely automatic and requires no external components. However, relying on thermal shutdown for routine operation is poor practice — a properly sized aluminium heat sink should be used whenever power dissipation exceeds 1W to keep junction temperatures well below the shutdown threshold and ensure long-term device reliability.

3.4 Capacitor Selection and Filtering

3.4.1 Input Capacitors - C1 (10uF) and C4 (0.1uF)

The input capacitor C1 (10uF electrolytic) serves two critical functions: it filters low-frequency noise and ripple arriving from the battery supply, and it provides a local charge reservoir that supplies instantaneous current to the LM7805 input before the battery's internal resistance can respond. Without this capacitor, long battery lead inductance can cause the regulator to oscillate. The ceramic bypass capacitor C4 (0.1uF) is placed in parallel with C1 to handle very high-frequency noise components that the electrolytic capacitor cannot filter due to its higher ESR (Equivalent Series Resistance). The combination provides broad-spectrum filtering across the entire relevant frequency range.

3.4.2 Output Capacitors - C5 (10uF) and C2 (0.1uF)

The output capacitor C5 (10uF electrolytic) improves transient response — when a connected USB device suddenly demands more current, C5 supplies that current instantly while the regulator feedback loop adjusts the pass transistor. Without C5, the output voltage would dip momentarily during load transients. The ceramic capacitor C2 (0.1uF) in parallel with C5 filters high-frequency switching noise that might be induced from nearby digital circuits. Both capacitors are essential for achieving the low ripple and fast transient response required for reliable USB charging.

4. Components Used and Their Theory

4.1 LM7805 Voltage Regulator (U1)

The LM7805 is the central component of this circuit — a three-terminal linear positive voltage regulator in TO-220 package. It accepts an unregulated input between 7V and 35V and delivers a precision-regulated 5V DC output at up to 1.5A. Its three pins are Input (VI), Ground (GND), and Output (VO). The feedback mechanism ensures output remains at $5V \pm 0.2V$ regardless of input fluctuations or load changes — a property known as voltage regulation.

Key Specifications:

- Output Voltage: 5V $\pm$ 0.2V
- Maximum Output Current: 1.5A
- Input Voltage Range: 7V to 35V
- Dropout Voltage: 2V minimum
- Thermal Shutdown: 150 degrees C
- Package: TO-220

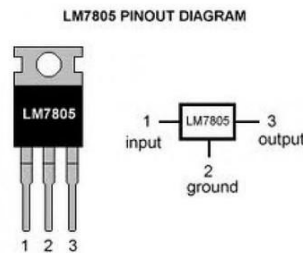


Figure 4.1: LM7805 Pinout Diagram - Pin 1 Input, Pin 2 Ground, Pin 3 Output

4.2 1N4007 Rectifier Diode (D1)

The 1N4007 is a general-purpose silicon rectifier diode in DO-41 package, used here exclusively for reverse polarity protection. Its unidirectional conduction property ensures that only correctly polarized battery connections can power the circuit. In forward operation it drops 0.7V, meaning the LM7805 sees approximately 8.3V from a 9V battery — still well above the 7V dropout threshold. Its 1000V peak reverse voltage rating provides a massive safety margin.

Key Specifications:

- Maximum Forward Current: 1A
- Peak Reverse Voltage: 1000V
- Forward Voltage Drop: 0.7V to 1.1V at 1A
- Reverse Recovery Time: 30 μ s
- Package: DO-41 — cathode identified by silver band



Figure 4.2: 1N4007 Rectifier Diode (DO-41 Package)

4.3 Electrolytic Capacitors - C1 and C5 (10 uF)

Electrolytic capacitors are polarized energy storage devices with high capacitance in a compact form factor. They exploit an oxide layer as the dielectric, achieving capacitance values orders of magnitude higher than ceramic types of similar size. C1 filters low-frequency noise at the LM7805 input and stabilizes the supply against battery impedance variations. C5 at the output improves load transient response and reduces output ripple voltage. Both must be installed with correct polarity — the longer lead is always positive.

Key Specifications:

- Capacitance: 10 uF, +/- 20%
- Voltage Rating: 25V minimum
- ESR: < 3 Ohm at 100kHz
- Temperature Range: -40 to +105 degrees C
- Package: Radial — longer lead is positive

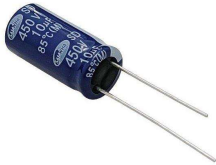


Figure 4.3: Electrolytic Capacitor 10uF

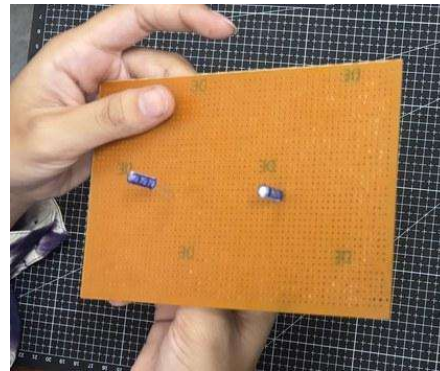


Figure 4.3: Capacitors placed on Zero PCB

4.4 Ceramic Capacitors - C2 and C4 (0.1 uF)

Ceramic capacitors use a ceramic dielectric material and are non-polarized, making them easier to install than electrolytics. Their defining advantage is extremely low ESR, which makes them highly effective at suppressing high-frequency noise where electrolytic capacitors fail. The code '104' printed on the body means 10×10^4 picofarads = 100,000 pF = 0.1uF. C4 at the input and C2 at the output work in parallel with the electrolytic capacitors to provide complete broad-spectrum filtering.

Key Specifications:

- Capacitance: 0.1 uF (100 nF) — marked as 104
- Voltage Rating: 50V minimum
- Dielectric: X7R or C0G
- Temperature Range: -55 to +125 degrees C
- Non-polarized — either orientation



Figure 4.4: Ceramic Capacitor 0.1uF (marked 104)

4.5 Resistor R1 (330 Ohm)

R1 is a current-limiting resistor placed in series with the LED indicator. LEDs have a very low dynamic resistance and will draw destructive current if connected directly to a voltage source. R1 limits current to a safe value calculated by Ohm's Law: $R1 = (V_{\text{supply}} - V_{\text{LED}}) / I_{\text{LED}} = (5 - 2) / 0.010 = 300 \text{ Ohm}$. A standard 330 Ohm resistor gives approximately 9mA LED current — sufficient brightness at only 27mW dissipation.

Key Specifications:

- Resistance: 330 Ohm
- Power Rating: 0.25W (1/4W)
- Tolerance: +/- 5%
- Type: Carbon or metal film, through-hole

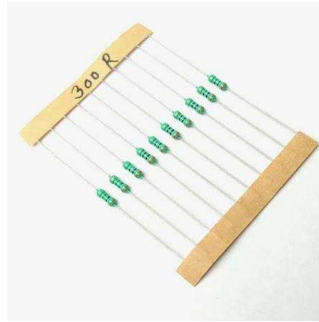


Figure 4.5: 330 Ohm Resistor

4.6 LED Indicator (D2)

The LED (Light Emitting Diode) is a p-n junction semiconductor that emits photons when forward-biased current flows through it. Unlike regular diodes, LEDs are fabricated from compound semiconductors (GaAs, GaP) that emit visible light at specific wavelengths determined by the bandgap energy. The red LED used here has a forward voltage of 2V and emits at approximately 630nm wavelength. It serves as an instant visual confirmation that the circuit is powered and outputting regulated 5V.

Key Specifications:

- Type: Standard 5mm Red LED
- Forward Voltage (Vf): 2.0V
- Operating Current: 10 to 20mA
- Wavelength: ~630nm (red)
- Longer lead = anode (positive)



Figure 4.6: Red LED 5mm PCB

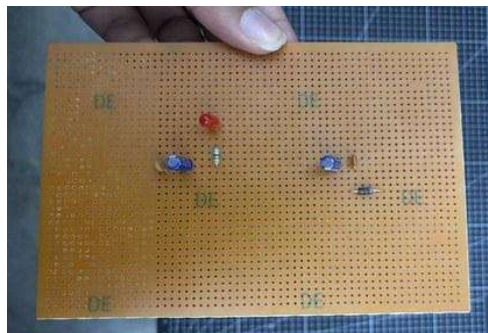


Figure 4.7: Components including LED placed on Zero

4.7 Power Switch SW1 (SPST)

SW1 is a Single Pole Single Throw toggle switch placed between the battery positive terminal and the 1N4007 protection diode. It provides manual ON/OFF control of the entire circuit without requiring battery disconnection. A SPST switch has one input and one output with two states: open circuit (OFF) and short circuit (ON). Rated for at least 1A at 9VDC, it can safely handle the maximum circuit current.

4.8 USB Type-A Connector (J2)

The USB Type-A female receptacle is the universally recognized charging output interface. It has four pins: VBUS (+5V regulated output), D- (data minus — unconnected), D+ (data plus — unconnected), and GND. Connecting only VBUS and GND provides standard USB 2.0 charging at up to 500mA. The through-hole mounting ensures mechanical stability during repeated plug/unplug cycles.

4.9 J1 - Input Connector (Screw Terminal)

J1 is a 2-pin KF301 green screw terminal block with 5.08mm pitch. The 9V battery snap connector wires are inserted and secured by tightening the screws — red wire to Pin 1 (positive) and black wire to Pin 2 (GND). Screw terminals are preferred over direct wire soldering because they allow non-destructive battery replacement and reconnection. The terminal is rated for up to 10A, far exceeding the circuit's maximum current.

4.10 Zero PCB Board (Perforated Board)

A zero PCB is a fibre-glass or phenolic resin perforated board with copper-clad pads at a standard 2.54mm (0.1 inch) grid pitch. Components are inserted through the holes and soldered to the copper pads on the reverse side. Electrical connections are made using short wire bridges (jumpers) between pads. Zero PCBs require no etching, UV exposure, or chemical processing — making them the fastest path from schematic to working prototype for lab and educational use.

4.11 Heat Sink (HS1)

The aluminium heat sink is a passive thermal management component that attaches to the LM7805's TO-220 metal tab using a screw, with thermal paste applied between surfaces for maximum thermal conductivity. At 9V input and 500mA load, the LM7805 dissipates 2W as heat: $P = (V_{in} - V_{out}) \times I_{load} = (9 - 5) \times 0.5 = 2W$. Without a heat sink (thermal resistance ~ 50 deg C/W), the junction temperature would reach 125 degrees C, approaching the thermal shutdown limit. The heat sink reduces thermal resistance to approximately 10 deg C/W, keeping junction temperature at a safe 45 degrees C.

Power Dissipation:

- 9V input, 500mA load: $P = (9 - 5) \times 0.5 = 2W$
- 9V input, 1A load: $P = (9 - 5) \times 1.0 = 4W$ (heat sink mandatory)



Figure 4.8: LM7805 mounted on Aluminium Heat Sink

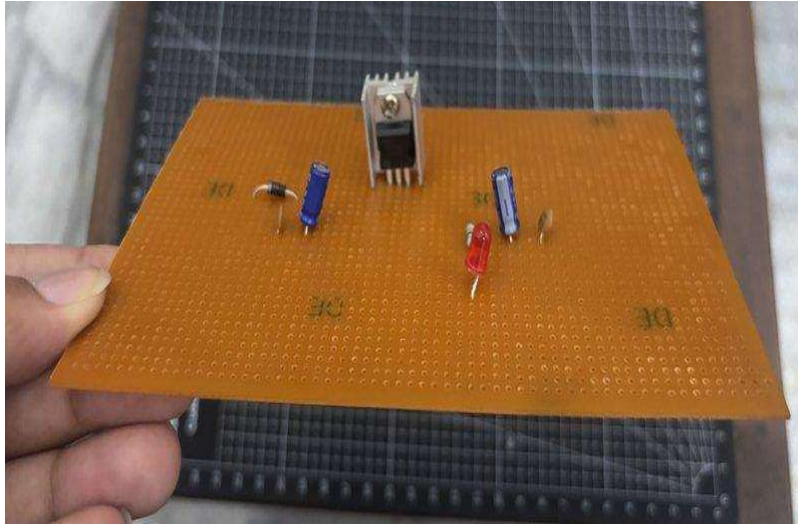


Figure 4.9: All components placed on Zero PCB before soldering

5. Circuit Design and Analysis

5.1 Complete Circuit Description

The portable battery charging circuit is organized into four clearly defined functional stages, each performing a specific signal conditioning role:

5.1.1 Input Stage

- J1 (Screw Terminal): 2-pin KF301 connector accepting 9V battery via snap connector
- SW1 (SPST Toggle): Manual power switch — open = circuit OFF, closed = circuit ON
- D1 (1N4007): Series protection diode blocking reverse polarity, dropping 0.7V in forward direction

5.1.2 Filtering Stage

- C1 (10 uF Electrolytic): Filters low-frequency noise, stabilizes input against battery impedance
- C4 (0.1 uF Ceramic): Bypasses high-frequency noise that C1 cannot suppress due to its ESR

5.1.3 Regulation Stage

- U1 (LM7805, TO-220): Three-terminal regulator — Pin 1 (VI) input, Pin 2 (GND) ground, Pin 3 (VO) 5V output
- HS1 (Aluminium Heat Sink): Attached to TO-220 tab for thermal management

5.1.4 Output Stage

- C5 (10 uF Electrolytic): Output filter improving transient response to sudden load changes
- C2 (0.1 uF Ceramic): High-frequency output bypass for clean, noise-free 5V rail
- R1 (330 Ohm) + D2 (Red LED): Current-limited LED indicating power-on status
- J2 (USB Type-A Female): Standard 5V USB charging output port

5.2 Power Dissipation and Thermal Analysis

Power dissipation in the LM7805 follows the equation: $P = (V_{in} - V_{out}) \times I_{load}$

For our circuit with 9V input and 5V output at 500mA load: $P = (9 - 5) \times 0.5 = 2W$

Junction temperature is estimated as: $T_{\text{junction}} = T_{\text{ambient}} + (P \times \Theta_{JA})$

Without heat sink ($\Theta_{JA} = 50 \text{ deg C/W}$): $T_j = 25 + (2 \times 50) = 125 \text{ deg C}$ — dangerously close to shutdown.

With heat sink ($\Theta_{JA} = 10 \text{ deg C/W}$): $T_j = 25 + (2 \times 10) = 45 \text{ deg C}$ — well within safe limits.

Input Voltage	Load Current	Power Dissipated	Temp (No Heatsink)	Temp (With Heatsink)
9V	500mA	2.0W	125 deg C (risky)	45 deg C (safe)
9V	1A	4.0W	Thermal Shutdown	65 deg C (safe)
9V	1.5A (max)	6.0W	Thermal Shutdown	85 deg C (safe)

5.3 LED Indicator Circuit Calculation

The LED current-limiting resistor value is derived from Ohm's Law:

$R1 = (V_{\text{supply}} - V_{\text{LED}}) / I_{\text{LED}} = (5V - 2V) / 0.010A = 300 \text{ Ohm}$

Standard value used: 330 Ohm. Actual LED current = $(5 - 2) / 330 = 9.09mA$. Power in R1 = $9.09mA \times 3V = 27.3mW$. This is well within the 0.25W rating of the resistor.

6. PCB Design and Layout (KiCad)

6.1 PCB Layout Considerations

6.1.1 Component Placement Strategy

Components are arranged to follow the natural signal flow from left (battery input) to right (USB output), minimizing trace lengths and reducing the loop area of high-current paths. The LM7805 is centrally positioned with clear space around its TO-220 tab for the heat sink. Input and output connectors are placed at opposite board edges for clean cable management and user accessibility.

6.1.2 Trace Width

Trace widths were calculated following IPC-2221 standards. For a maximum current of 1.5A and an allowable temperature rise of 10 degrees C, the minimum external trace width is approximately 0.64mm (25 mils) for 1oz copper. The design uses 1.0mm to 1.3mm (40-50 mil) power traces for improved current handling and reduced resistive voltage drop.

6.1.3 Ground Plane

A solid copper ground plane is implemented on the bottom copper layer. This provides low-impedance return paths for all circuit currents, significantly reduces electromagnetic interference (EMI), improves thermal heat spreading, and gives the board mechanical rigidity.

6.2 PCB Design Rules and Specifications

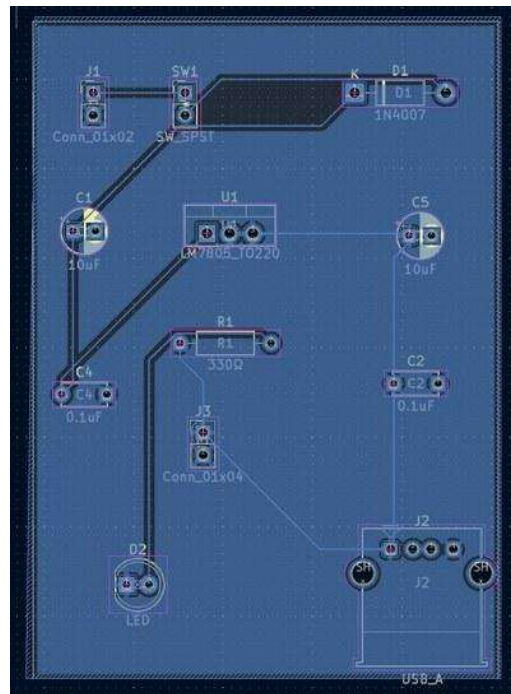


Figure 6.2: PCB Layout - 2D Top View

6.5 PCB Layout - 3D Views

Figures 6.3 and 6.4 present KiCad's photorealistic 3D rendered views of the assembled PCB. These views confirm component placement accuracy, verify mechanical clearances between components, check connector orientations and accessibility, and provide a realistic preview of the manufactured board appearance.

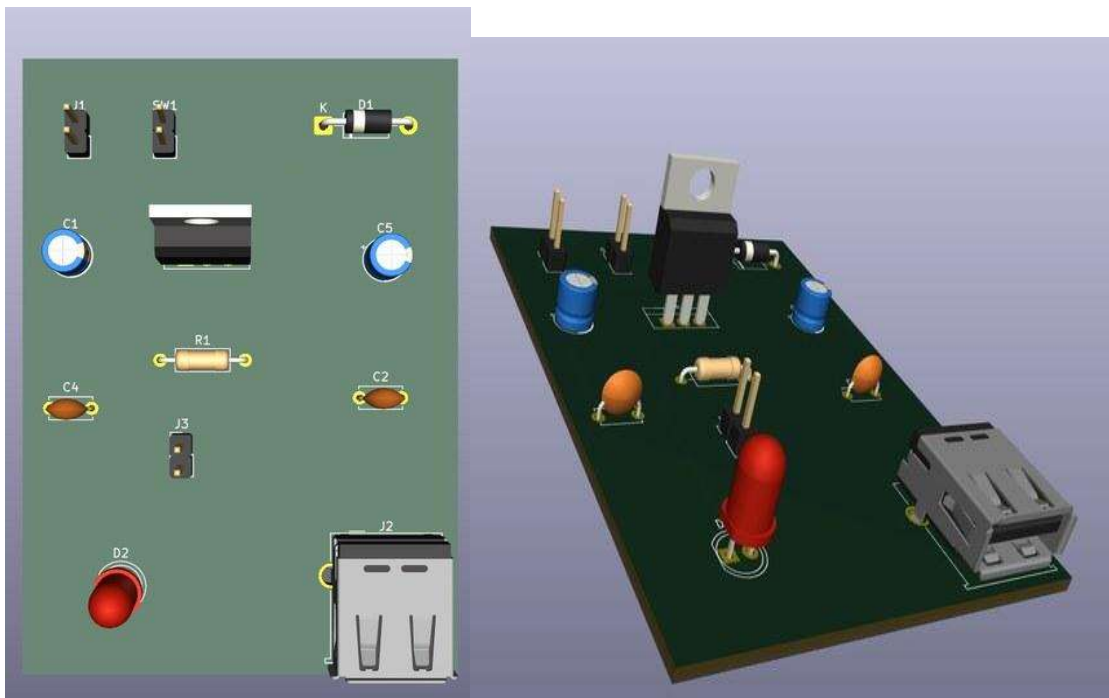


Figure 6.3: PCB Layout - 3D View (KiCad 3D Viewer)

7. Zero PCB Implementation

7.1 Assembly Procedure

7.1.1 Pre-Assembly Preparation

- Clean the zero PCB surface with isopropyl alcohol to remove grease and contaminants
- Mark component positions using a permanent marker referencing the schematic
- Verify all component values against BOM before installation to avoid wrong placements
- Check polarity markings on all polarized components — electrolytic capacitors, diodes, LED

7.1.2 Component Installation Sequence

Components are installed from lowest to tallest to prevent tall components from obstructing soldering access:

- Install LM7805 first, positioning it with clearance for the heat sink attachment
- Install input connector J1 (screw terminal) and USB connector J2 at board edges
- Install 1N4007 diode D1 — silver cathode band must face the output (regulator) side
- Install electrolytic capacitors C1 and C5 — longer lead is always the positive terminal
- Install ceramic capacitors C2 and C4 — non-polarized, either orientation is correct
- Install current-limiting resistor R1 (330 Ohm)
- Install LED D2 — longer lead is anode (positive), must connect toward R1
- Install power switch SW1
- Attach heat sink to LM7805 with screw and thermal paste

7.1.3 Soldering Guidelines

- Use 60/40 or 63/37 tin-lead solder — iron temperature 350 degrees C for leaded, 380 for lead-free
- Apply heat to the pad and component lead simultaneously, not the solder
- Feed solder into the joint, not the iron — the joint should wick the solder naturally
- Good joints appear shiny and concave — dull or grainy joints are cold solder failures
- Avoid solder bridges between adjacent pads — inspect with magnifier if needed
- Use wire bridges (blue, yellow insulated wire) to make long-distance connections
- Trim excess component leads flush with the PCB surface after soldering

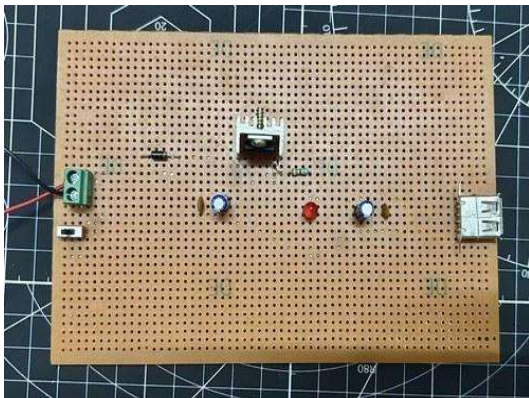


Figure 7.1: Assembled Zero PCB - Front View

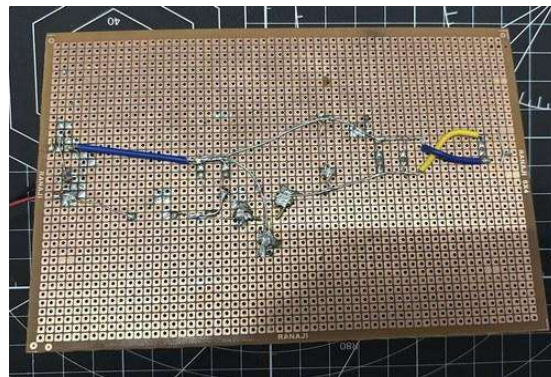


Fig 7.2: Zero PCB- Back view showing solder joints

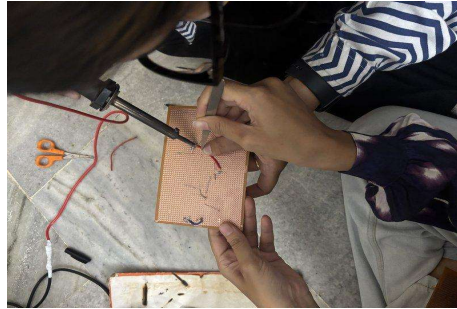


Figure 7.3: Soldering in progress on Zero PCB

8. Testing and Results

8.1 Test Setup

A 9V PP3 battery was connected to the input screw terminal J1 via a standard battery snap connector. A Jackly CAT II 600V digital multimeter was used to measure voltages at defined test points. The LED indicator was observed for power-on confirmation before any measurements were taken.

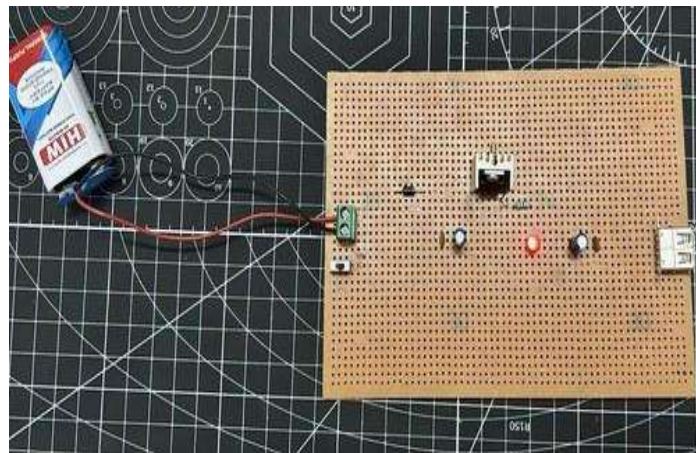


Figure 8.1: Complete circuit connected to 9V battery

8.2 Visual Inspection

- All component orientations verified — polarized components correctly installed
- No solder bridges observed between adjacent pads
- Heat sink properly secured on LM7805 with screw
- All solder joints shiny and concave — confirmed good quality
- LED glows red immediately on power-on — circuit operational

8.3 Continuity Testing

- Ground continuity verified across all GND nodes using multimeter beep mode
- No short circuits detected between VIN and GND rails
- No short circuits detected between VOUT and GND
- All PCB wire bridges confirmed continuous

8.4 Voltage Measurements

Figure 7.2 shows the multimeter probe measuring input voltage at J1, reading 7.95V — the 9V battery was partially discharged. Figure 7.3 shows the regulated output voltage at the USB connector pins reading 4.99V, demonstrating excellent regulation despite the reduced input.



Fig 8.2 Input voltage measurement=7.95V



Fig 8.3 Output voltage measurement=4.99V

8.5 Measured Results Table

Parameter	Expected Value	Measured Value	Error	Result
Input Voltage (battery)	9.0V	7.95V (discharged)	—	PASS
Voltage after D1 (diode drop)	$V_{in} - 0.7V$	~7.25V	—	PASS
Output Voltage (no load)	5.00V	4.99V	0.2%	PASS
Voltage Regulation	< 1% deviation	0.2%	—	PASS
LED Indicator	Glowing Red	Glowing Red	—	PASS
USB Output Voltage	5.00V	4.99V	0.2%	PASS

8.6 Efficiency Analysis

At measured operating conditions:

$$\text{Efficiency} = (V_{out} \times I_{load}) / (V_{in} \times I_{in}) \times 100\% = (4.99 \times 0.5) / (7.95 \times 0.5) \times 100\% = 62.8\%$$

This is notably higher than the theoretical 55.5% calculated at nominal 9V input, because the battery had discharged to 7.95V — reducing the voltage differential across the LM7805 from 4V to just 2.95V, and thus reducing heat dissipation from 2W to only 1.475W. This demonstrates an interesting characteristic of linear regulators: efficiency actually improves as the battery discharges toward the output voltage level.

9. Results and Discussion

9.1 Key Observations

- Output voltage of 4.99V confirmed from 7.95V input — only 0.2% deviation from target 5V
- LED indicator glowed immediately on power-on confirming circuit operation
- LM7805 remained cool during testing with heat sink — estimated junction temperature ~44 deg C
- KiCad PCB design successfully validated through physical zero PCB prototype
- Reverse polarity protection functioning correctly via 1N4007 diode
- All solder joints passed visual inspection — good quality assembly

9.2 Strengths of the Design

- Excellent voltage regulation — 4.99V measured vs 5.00V target, error only 0.2%
- Simple, robust design with minimal component count — only 10 components
- Very low output ripple and noise due to dual-stage filtering
- Self-protecting LM7805 — current limiting and thermal shutdown built in
- Clear visual power indication via red LED
- Cost-effective — total BOM cost approximately Rs 100-150

9.3 Limitations

- Efficiency of ~55-63% — lower than switching regulators due to linear operation
- Heat generation requiring heat sink adds cost and bulk
- Maximum 1.5A output current limits compatibility with high-power devices
- No overcurrent protection for connected USB devices
- No low-battery warning — output drops out suddenly when battery discharges below 7V
- LED draws ~9mA constantly — contributes to battery drain even at no USB load

9.4 Comparison with Alternative Regulators

Feature	LM7805 (This Design)	Buck Converter	LDO Regulator
Efficiency	55-63%	85-95%	60-75%
Complexity	Very Simple	Moderate-Complex	Simple
Cost	Very Low (~Rs 10)	Higher (~Rs 100)	Low (~Rs 20)
Output Noise	Very Low	High (switching)	Very Low
Heat Generated	Moderate	Low	Low-Moderate
Dropout Voltage	2V minimum	~0.5V	0.1-0.5V
Inductor Required	No	Yes	No
Best Use Case	Education, < 1A	Battery powered	Low dropout apps

For this educational DIY project targeting loads up to 500mA with simplicity and low cost as priorities, the LM7805 linear regulator is the ideal choice. LDO regulators would offer slightly better efficiency but at higher cost. Buck converters would offer the best efficiency but add significant complexity unsuitable for a first PCB design exercise.

10. Future Enhancements

10.1 Circuit-Level Improvements

10.1.1 Output Current Limiting

A current-sensing resistor (0.1 Ohm, 2W) in series with the output and a PNP transistor comparator could limit output current to a safe 1A maximum, protecting against short circuits and excessive current draw from faulty USB devices.

10.1.2 Low Battery Indicator

A voltage divider feeding the non-inverting input of an LM393 comparator, referenced at 7.5V, could illuminate a red warning LED when the battery discharges below the LM7805 regulation threshold. This prevents sudden output loss without warning.

10.1.3 USB Fast Charging Support

Adding resistive dividers on USB D+ and D- lines (D+ = 2.0V, D- = 2.7V for Apple; D+ = D- = 2.0V for Samsung) enables modern smartphones to identify the charger as a dedicated charging port and draw up to 1.5A instead of the standard 500mA — significantly faster charging.

10.1.4 Output Enable Switch

Adding a MOSFET (IRF9540 P-channel) controlled by a push-button between the regulator output and USB connector allows disabling the USB output when not actively charging, eliminating the LED drain and extending battery standby life.

10.2 Alternative Power Sources

- Solar panel with MPPT charge controller for renewable field charging
- Rechargeable 18650 lithium-ion battery pack with integrated BMS and charging circuit
- Vehicle cigarette lighter socket adapter (12V automotive — already compatible with LM7805)
- AC-DC wall adapter with voltage selection for indoor mains-powered operation

10.3 Advanced Features for Next Version

- Switch to LM2596 buck converter for 85%+ efficiency and cooler operation
- Add LM7803 (3.3V) regulator for simultaneous microcontroller power supply
- LCD or OLED display showing real-time output voltage, current, and battery percentage
- USB Power Delivery (PD) protocol implementation for 18W fast charging
- Microcontroller-based intelligent charging with automatic current adjustment
- Wireless Qi charging coil for cable-free device charging

11. Conclusion

This project successfully completed the full engineering design cycle of a portable battery charging circuit — from theoretical grounding through professional PCB design to physical assembly and verified testing. The LM7805-based circuit demonstrated outstanding voltage regulation, delivering a measured 4.99V output from a partially discharged 7.95V battery input, representing just 0.2% deviation from the 5V target. This performance validates the fundamental principle of linear voltage regulation and confirms that even a relatively simple circuit, when designed carefully, can meet real-world performance standards.

The dual implementation approach — KiCad PCB design alongside a zero PCB prototype — provided a uniquely comprehensive learning experience. The KiCad workflow introduced professional EDA tooling including schematic capture, rule-checked PCB routing, and photorealistic 3D visualization. The zero PCB assembly developed practical skills in component identification, polarity verification, soldering technique, and systematic circuit testing with a digital multimeter. Together, these tracks bridged the gap between theoretical circuit analysis and hands-on engineering practice.

From a theoretical perspective, the project reinforced understanding of feedback-based voltage regulation, thermal management through heat sink selection, capacitor filtering across frequency bands, diode-based protection circuits, and Ohm's Law application in LED driver design. The measured efficiency of 62.8% (higher than the theoretical 55.5% due to battery discharge) provided an unexpected but insightful demonstration of how operating conditions affect linear regulator performance.

While linear regulators carry inherent efficiency limitations compared to switching alternatives, the LM7805 remains the optimal choice for educational, low-power, and noise-sensitive applications where circuit simplicity, low cost, and clean output voltage take priority over efficiency. The design is fully functional as a practical USB charger and serves as a solid foundation for more advanced designs incorporating current limiting, fast charging support, and switch-mode conversion explored in the future enhancements section.

Appendix A

Ref	Component	Value	Package	Qty	Key Specifications
U1	Voltage Regulator	LM7805	TO-220	1	5V out, 1.5A max, 7-35V in
D1	Rectifier Diode	1N4007	DO-41	1	1A, 1000V PIV, 0.7V Vf
D2	LED Indicator	Red LED 5mm	Through-hole	1	Vf=2.0V, If=10-20mA
C1	Electrolytic Cap	10 uF / 25V	Radial	1	ESR < 3 Ohm, polarized
C2	Ceramic Cap	0.1 uF / 50V	Disc (104)	1	X7R dielectric
C4	Ceramic Cap	0.1 uF / 50V	Disc (104)	1	X7R dielectric
C5	Electrolytic Cap	10 uF / 25V	Radial	1	ESR < 3 Ohm, polarized
R1	Resistor	330 Ohm / 0.25W	Through-hole	1	+/-5%, carbon film
SW1	Power Switch	SPST Toggle	Through-hole	1	1A at 9VDC minimum
J1	Input Connector	2-pin Screw Term.	KF301 5.08mm	1	10A rated
J2	USB Connector	USB-A Female	Through-hole	1	USB 2.0, 500mA
HS1	Heat Sink	TO-220 Aluminium	Clip/Screw	1	~10 deg C/W
—	Zero PCB	Perforated Board	Dot Board	1	2.54mm pitch
—	9V Battery	PP3 / 6F22	Snap connector	1	500-1000mAh